

September 3rd 2019 Delaware County Commissioners Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eme45GmlveY
Publication Date	2019-09-05T20:33:33Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Report

Meeting Date: September 30, 2019

Location: Delaware County, Indiana

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Delaware County Commissioners was called to order at 9:00 AM by the presiding officer [00:00:10](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Ding, Mr. Henry, Ms. Reagan, and Becky [00:00:58](#).
 - **Members Absent:** (None noted in transcript).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named by title, though managing the proceedings.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with a moment of silence followed by the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:16](#).

- **Citizen Recognitions:** John Libby was sworn in as the appointed supervisor for the Delaware County Soil and Water Conservation District for a three-year term by Becky Dory [00:01:12](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** Approved via roll call vote (Mr. Henry: Yes, Mr. Ding: Yes, Ms. Reagan: Yes) [00:02:24](#).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:02:40](#) **County Highway Department Personnel Handbook**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Highway Department representative.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The department presented its unique personnel handbook, patterned after and mirroring the county's handbook except for specific security provisions relevant to the highway department.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Mr. Henry: Yes, Mr. Ding: Yes, Ms. Reagan: Yes) [00:03:19](#).
- [00:03:35](#) **Court Recording Equipment Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Court Administrator.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** An agreement for recording equipment for the new court facility, funded using incentive money so county taxes will not cover the cost. Equipment will be stored locally until the new facility is ready for installation.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** (Approved via subsequent context/proceedings).
- [00:04:17](#) **Progress Rail Services Variance Request & Bridge Consulting Contracts**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Engineering / Highway Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding a variance request for Progress Rail Services. Additionally, the board addressed Bridge 161 consulting contract modifications, separating out right-of-way buying and negotiations to save approximately \$60,000 to \$70,000 by evaluating the existing structure rather than replacing it. A public hearing regarding Bridge 160 was also reviewed, noting neighbor concerns regarding speeding and trespassing.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Mr. Henry: Yes, Mr. King: Yes, Ms. Reagan: Yes) [00:05:09](#).
- [00:07:46](#) **Land Acquisition for South Trails Area**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** BS Engineering (Engineering firm for the Redevelopment Commission).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for settlement compensation totaling \$16,000 for four acres of land to be used for trails south of town, avoiding litigation costs.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Mr. Henry: Yes, Mr. King: Yes, Ms. Reagan: Yes) [00:08:44](#).
- [00:09:08](#) **Contractual Services Agreement for Building Commissioner**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Department Head / Administration.

- **Deliberation Summary:** An agreement to retain outgoing Building Commissioner Steve Minich under a contractual service rate until a new full-time position (approved by County Council at a salary of \$36,721) can be filled, ensuring a smooth transition.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Mr. Henry: Yes, Mr. King: Yes, Ms. Reagan: Yes) [00:10:49](#).
 - [00:11:29](#) **Ordinance 2019-018: New Grant Fund Creation (Health Department)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jam-band, Health Department Administrator.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Creation of a new fund number required by the state level for an ongoing federal grant, improving accountability for federal grant spending in compliance with county audit standards.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Introduction of Ordinance 2019-018: Approved by roll call vote [00:13:44](#).
 - Motion to suspend the rules: Approved by roll call vote [00:13:57](#).
 - Final adoption of Ordinance 2019-018: Passed Unanimously by roll call vote (Mr. Henry: Yes, Mr. King: Yes, Ms. Reagan: Yes) [00:14:11](#).
 - [00:14:26](#) **Convention & Visitors Bureau Insurance and Benefit Inquiry (Tabled)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John / Legal Counsel.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding a request from the Convention Tourism Commission to bring their employees into the county's insurance and benefit plans. Commissioners expressed concern over self-insurance liability, the \$200,000 stop-loss threshold, and potential financial exposure for the county if the bureau lacks funds.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled for further review with insurance carriers and the State Board of Accounts [00:16:07](#).
 - [00:26:41](#) **9-1-1 Center Grant and Upgrade Project**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** 9-1-1 Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Update on a state-awarded grant received following a commitment made in October 2018. The total project cost is \$1,395,000, with \$630,000 reimbursed by the state. The director proposed allocating \$350,000 from the state 9-1-1 account (Account 1222). Contract updates remove network and selective routing database management fees, saving the county \$722,000 over ten years.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Received and discussed (no formal vote recorded in transcript excerpt).
 - [00:33:32](#) **Claims Approval**
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Payment of claims totaling \$1,509,309.45 approved by roll call vote (Mr. King: Yes, [other commissioners affirmative]) [00:33:34](#).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:34:04 Jeff Waters:** Shared his personal survival story of contracting West Nile virus one year ago, which resulted in seven months of paralysis and 100 days in a nursing home. He strongly urged the commissioners to increase public awareness campaigns, publicity, and mosquito spraying/fogging efforts to protect public health.
 - *Board Response:* Health department representatives explained that a full-scale vector control fogging program is resource-intensive, requiring multiple trucks, staff, and expensive chemicals (\$11,000 per 55-gallon drum), noting that current efforts focus primarily on larval control in ditches and standing water.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Nate Jones (Delaware County Veterans Affairs) invited the commissioners to the Delaware County Stand Down and Resource Fair at the fairgrounds' Heartland Building, noting that their office is the only county-level VA office in Indiana to host such an event. He also invited them to the next VA meeting on Friday at 1:00 PM at the Daleville American Legion **00:19:16**.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was recessed/adjourned following the public comment period **00:42:17**.
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